

Legal Contract Review Copilot

Every step, start to finish, including the current (2026) way to build the tool in Step 6 — an agent flow calling DocuSign/Adobe Sign and writing back to SharePoint.

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What You're Building

An agent that triages contract renewal exposure and kicks off e-signature in conversation, grounded in one data file, acting through one governed tool.

AGENT NAME	Legal Contract Review Copilot
ORCHESTRATION	Generative (AI-led)
KNOWLEDGE	Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx
CUSTOM TOPIC	Triage Renewal Exposure
TOOL	Send Contract to E-Signature (agent flow → DocuSign/Adobe Sign + SharePoint)

Files & Where They Go

FILE / ITEM	GOES TO	USED IN
Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx	Copilot Studio → Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File	Step 3
DocuSign or Adobe Sign connection	Authorize the connector in Power Automate before Step 6	Step 6

DocuSign/Adobe Sign are premium connectors — confirm your tenant's Power Platform licensing covers premium connector usage before building this flow.

Before you start — confirm Environment Maker permission, an active DocuSign or Adobe Sign account/API connection, and Edit access on the SharePoint contracts library.

Set Up the Agent

Steps 1–3 — create the agent shell, pick how it reasons, and ground it in data.

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create** → **New agent**, then configure:

AGENT NAME	Legal Contract Review Copilot
DESCRIPTION	Reviews NDAs, MSAs, vendor agreements and licence deals — flags risky clauses against the internal playbook, surfaces renewal exposure, and summarises change requests for counsel.
SOLUTION / ENVIRONMENT	Legal Solution · Default environment
ICON	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under **Settings** → **Generative AI**, use **Generative Orchestration** (AI-led) so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for contract review and renewal exposure.

3 Add Knowledge

Knowledge tab → **Add knowledge** → **File** → upload **Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx**. Contains:

- Contract metadata (ID, counterparty, type — NDA / MSA / Vendor / Licence)
- Lifecycle dates (effective date, expiry date, auto-renew flag)
- Risk signals (risk flag, risk reason, governing law)
- Commercial and status (annual value USD, owner, status — Draft / Active / Expiring / Expired / Terminated)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

Behavior: Instructions & Topic

Steps 4–5 — tell the agent how to behave, then give it a reusable conversation flow.

4 Add Agent Instructions

Overview → Instructions — paste exactly:

You are the Legal Contract Review Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) In-house counsel and contract owners reviewing the portfolio.
- 2) Business owners asking about a specific contract they manage.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded contracts dataset as your single source of truth.
- Never provide binding legal advice. Always recommend counsel review for interpretation or signature decisions.
- When a clause is flagged High risk, surface the RiskReason verbatim and cite the contract ID.
- For actions (send to e-signature, request a redline), call the tool.
- Treat counterparty information as confidential – never reveal another business unit's contract terms to an owner who does not own it.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Topics → Add a topic → Create from description:

Topic name: Triage Renewal Exposure

Description: Walks the user through the contracts expiring in a chosen window, highlights High risk and auto-renew traps, and offers to start the renewal workflow on a chosen contract.

Trigger phrases:

- What's expiring in the next 90 days
- Show me my renewal exposure
- Which contracts auto-renew soon
- Help me triage upcoming expiries

Conversation steps:

- Ask for the time window (default: next 90 days)
- Filter contracts where ExpiryDate falls in the window, sort by AnnualValueUSD desc
- Highlight rows where AutoRenew = Y and RiskFlag in (Med, High)
- For each row, cite ContractID, Counterparty, ExpiryDate, RiskReason
- Ask which contract to action; if chosen, call 'Send Contract to E-Signature'
- Confirm envelope ID returned by the tool and remind the user to notify counsel

Build the Tool (Current Method)

Step 6 — updated for 2026, using current Copilot Studio tool-building.

6a Authorize the E-Signature Connection

In Power Automate, add a connection for **DocuSign** or **Adobe Sign** (whichever your organisation uses) before building the flow — both are premium connectors requiring an account/API key.

6b Build the Agent Flow

1. **Flows** → **New flow** → **Agent flow**.
2. Trigger inputs: **ContractID**, **SignerName**, **SignerEmail**, **CounterSignerEmail**, **EffectiveDate**, **Note**.
3. Action: **SharePoint** — **Get file content** → the latest version of the contract document.
4. Action: **DocuSign/Adobe Sign** — **Create and send envelope** → attach the file, set signer and counter-signer.
5. Action: **SharePoint** — **Update item** → write the returned envelope ID back onto the contract row.
6. Action: **Teams** — **Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a channel** → Legal Operations.
7. **Respond to the agent** → output **EnvelopeID**. Confirm **Asynchronous response** = **Off**.
8. **Publish** the flow.

6c Attach It as a Tool

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → filter by **Flow** → select it → **Add and configure**.
2. **Name**: Send Contract to E-Signature. **Description**: "Sends the latest contract version to e-signature and records the envelope ID."
3. Under **Completion**, respond using **EnvelopeID**.
4. **Save**.

Original spec, for reference — Tool: Send Contract to E-Signature. Type: Power Automate flow → DocuSign / Adobe Sign connector + SharePoint write-back. Sends the latest version of a contract from SharePoint to an e-signature envelope and records the envelope ID against the row. Inputs: Contract ID (string, from knowledge); Signer name and signer email (string); Counter-signer email (string, optional — counsel); Effective date (date); Note to signer (string, optional). Outcome: Returns the e-signature envelope ID and posts a status card to the Legal Operations Teams channel.

Configure, Evaluate, Test, Publish

Steps 7–10 — lock down settings, prove quality, and ship it.

7 Configure Settings

Settings cog (top right) — four areas before real users touch the agent:

- **General** — confirm name, description, primary language
- **Generative AI** — orchestration mode, content moderation (start at Medium)
- **Authentication** — "Authenticate with Microsoft" so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- **Security** — review DLP policy, enabled channels, end-user authentication

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Analytics → **Evaluations** → **New evaluation** — "Legal Contract Review Copilot — Baseline v1". Score every response on Groundedness, Relevance, Accuracy.

Input: List all contracts expiring in the next 60 days, highest value first
Expect: Returns rows where ExpiryDate is within 60 days, ordered by AnnualValueUSD desc.

Input: Which auto-renewing vendor agreements are flagged High risk?
Expect: Filters Type=Vendor AND AutoRenew=Y AND RiskFlag=High, cites contract IDs.

Input: Send contract C-1042 to e-signature with Jordan Park as signer
Expect: Triggers the Triage Renewal Exposure topic and calls Send Contract to E-Signature.

9 Test in the Test Pane

For each query, open **Activity map** to see: which topic/tool/knowledge fired, the inputs collected and outputs returned, citations to source rows, and per-step latency.

10 Publish to a Channel

Recommended for this build: Microsoft Teams (Legal Operations channel). Pin the agent there for counsel and ops; surface in **Microsoft 365 Copilot** for licensed business owners; embed on the Legal intranet page for quick lookups; or link the agent from the SharePoint Contracts library landing page. Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval.

Try These Live

Sample queries to run once the agent is built — and what it replaces.

Portfolio Triage

- What's expiring in the next 90 days, sorted by annual value?
- Show all High risk contracts that auto-renew.

Specific Lookups

- Summarise the risk profile for contract C-1042.
- Which contracts have governing law outside the US or UK?

Governed Action

- Send the renewed NDA for Northwind Logistics to e-signature.
- Try a paraphrase: 'kick off signature for the AlpenTech MSA'.

This agent replaces

- Manual playbook checks against each contract
- Spreadsheet renewal trackers refreshed by hand
- Email chains chasing signatures

With

- Risk and renewal exposure surfaced in chat
- E-signature kicked off in a single conversation
- Counsel always cited and in the loop

Tip for real-world use — layer SharePoint document library permissions on the Knowledge source so business owners see only contracts they own, while counsel sees the full portfolio. Route e-signature through an approval step above your delegation threshold.